EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

I. Recommendation

NEXIUM™ (esomeprazole magnesium; H 199/18), the s-enantiomer of omeprazole and the first proton pump inhibitor (PPI) to be developed as a single isomer, is a substituted benzimidazole derivative that suppresses gastric acid secretion by specific inhibition of the H^+/K^+-ATPase enzyme system. Like its parent compound (omeprazole) and other PPIs, NEXIUM blocks the final step of gastric secretion and produces dose-related sustained inhibition of both basal and stimulated gastric acid secretion. Like omeprazole and the other approved PPIs, NEXIUM is of benefit in the three gastroesophageal reflux disease (GERD) related indications that require gastric acid inhibition. These indications are: treatment of erosive esophagitis, maintenance of healing of erosive esophagitis, and treatment of symptomatic GERD. GERD is a chronic recurring and potentially serious, debilitating condition characterized by symptoms of heartburn and regurgitation. Chronic GERD can lead to morbidity ranging from mild esophageal mucosal inflammation to erosions, ulceration, esophageal stricture and, in some patients, transformation to Barrett's esophagus, a premalignant condition. The data presented by the sponsor in NDA 21-153 demonstrate that NEXIUM a) affords rates of healing which are comparable to omeprazole in the treatment of erosive esophagitis; b) is highly effective in the maintenance of healing of erosive esophagitis and c) provides significantly better rates of symptom resolution within 4 weeks than placebo in patients with symptomatic GERD (s-GERD).

The above-described benefits outweigh the potential risks of this drug. Results of pre-clinical evaluations showed that, at equivalent systemic exposure, H 199/18 is pharmacologically and toxicological (including genotoxicity) similar to omeprazole. Like omeprazole, esomeprazole may be administered with adequate safety to humans at the recommended oral doses and treatment duration. Because NEXIUM™ is the s-enantiomer of omeprazole and omeprazole is a PPI that is perceived as safe, NEXIUM is also considered safe. Omeprazole has been marketed worldwide since 1988 and is presently available in 106 countries for various acid-related gastrointestinal disorders. There have been an estimated ——— courses of patient treatments of omeprazole from the time of its introduction into the market through June 30, 1998. This estimate includes all oral formulations of omeprazole. Some patients have received continuous treatment with omeprazole in monitored clinical trials for longer than 13 years [NDA ———, 4 August 1999. General Correspondence, omeprazole ———————, an extensive clinical experience that confirms that omeprazole is – all things considered safe and well-tolerated. Throughout its development and marketing, certain safety issues have been adequately monitored with omeprazole use and comprehensive updates of these topics have been submitted to the Division. It is concluded that based on the clinical experience with esomeprazole, involving over 5,000 patients and subjects, this drug shares the same overall acceptable safety profile of omeprazole.

The drug is approvable **from a clinical perspective.** No need for risk management actions is anticipated.

There are neither recommended Phase 4 trials nor marketing restrictions. Public outreach or information is not needed.